Budget, revenue model and payback

All figures in KZT. Planning assumptions are labelled; case facts come from the official brief.

1. Business model

Who pays: foreign travelers pay Saryarqa Routes for guided trips booked through the app. The app is not sold to anyone; it is a sales channel that turns foreign interest into paid bookings.

Revenue stream	How it works	In the model?
Margin on additional foreign travelers	Average price 44,000 KZT Case fact × contribution margin 30% Proposal = 13,200 KZT per traveler, after direct tour costs and payment fees	Yes, the only revenue counted
Optional extras	Horse rides, boats, single rooms, photo sessions sold on the tour page	No (upside)
Multi-tour trips	Trip builder combines tours, raising spend per traveler	No (upside)
Referrals	Postcard links bring friends at low acquisition cost	No (upside)

Only one stream is counted so the result is conservative. Note: 150,000,000 ÷ 3,400 = 44,118 KZT, slightly above the stated 44,000 KZT average; the model uses 44,000.

2. Budget: development, launch and maintenance

Block	Item	Type	KZT
Development	Design and development	one-time	8,000,000
	Localization EN / 中文	one-time	1,500,000
	Payment integration and testing	one-time	1,500,000
	Trust content: guide videos, photos	one-time	1,000,000
Launch	Marketing and acquisition (Xiaohongshu, WeChat, partners)	year 1	4,500,000
	Pilot and support	year 1	1,000,000
Maintenance	Hosting, AI usage, maintenance	year 1	1,500,000
Reserve	Contingency	year 1	1,000,000
Total year 1 (case limit: up to 20,000,000 KZT Case fact)			**20,000,000**

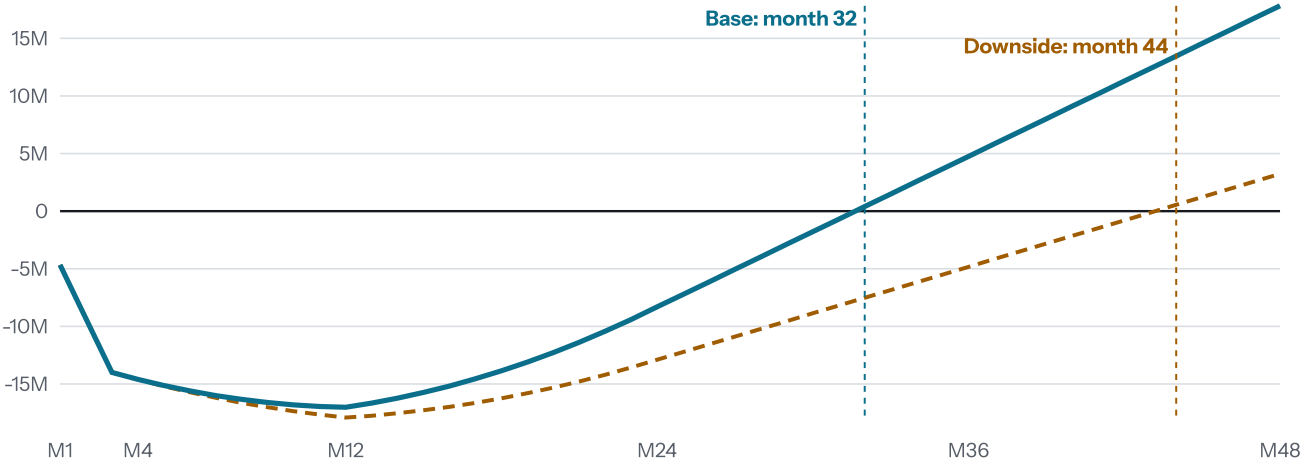
After year 1, running costs (hosting, support, marketing upkeep) are assumed at **300,000 KZT per month = 3,600,000 KZT per year** Proposal. All budget lines are planning assumptions Proposal to be confirmed with at least two quotes.

3. Volume assumption

Goal: 30% foreign travelers within 24 months Case fact. Today ≈ 136 foreign travelers (4% of 3,400). Keeping ≈ 3,264 domestic travelers, 30% foreign means ≈ 4,663 total and ≈ 1,399 foreign, so **≈ 1,263 additional foreign travelers per year** by month 24. Launch is in month 4; volume ramps linearly from launch to the full run rate in month 24 (month *m* gets (m − 3) ÷ 21 of it), then stays flat.

4. Payback model

Formula. Monthly net = additional travelers × 13,200 − costs. Costs: 12.0M one-time spread over months 1-3; the other 8.0M over months 1-12; 300,000 per month from month 13. Payback = first month in which cumulative cash is ≥ 0. **Downside scenario:** 30% fewer travelers than planned (× 0.7), everything else unchanged.



Cumulative cash over 48 months. Solid: base case. Dashed: downside (travelers × 0.7).

Year	Add. travelers (base)	Contribution	Costs	Net	Cumulative base	Cumulative downside
Year 1	226	3.0M	20.0M	-17.0M	-17.0M	-17.9M
Year 2	932	12.3M	3.6M	8.7M	-8.3M	-12.9M
Year 3	1,263	16.7M	3.6M	13.1M	4.8M	-4.8M
Year 4	1,263	16.7M	3.6M	13.1M	17.8M	3.2M

Results

	Base	Downside
Lowest cumulative cash	-17.0M	-17.9M
Cumulative cash, month 24	-8.3M	-12.9M
Payback month	**32**	**44**
Cumulative cash, month 48	17.8M	3.2M
Break-even travelers (20M ÷ 13,200)	1,516	1,516

Sensitivity to the margin assumption

Margin	Payback base	Payback downside
20%	month 46	> 48 months
25%	month 37	> 48 months
30% (default)	month 32	month 44
35%	month 29	month 38
40%	month 27	month 34

Reading it honestly. The base case pays back within 48 months for any margin from 20% up. The downside needs a margin of about 30% or more, so the margin is the first number to check with the company's real costs. If the pilot shows weaker demand, the levers are: shift marketing to referrals and organic Xiaohongshu content, delay paid ads, and keep running costs at the 300,000 KZT per month floor. The model is also live and adjustable on the Impact page of the prototype.